

Nova

Reimagining the Academic Interface

Project Timeline: April 1, 2026 – May 20, 2026

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This Software Requirements Specification (SRS) document details the functional and non-functional requirements for **Nova**, a GUI-centric mock university website. The primary purpose of this project is to visually simulate a real university portal by emphasizing layout structure, visual hierarchy, consistency, and intuitive navigation.

1.2 Document Conventions

This document follows the standard IEEE formatting guidelines for an SRS. Requirements are classified into Functional Dependencies (FR) and Non-Functional Dependencies (NFR), strictly focusing on frontend GUI principles and browser-based logic rather than backend functionality.

1.3 Project Scope

The scope of Nova encompasses a practical sandbox for experimenting with UI/UX design and browser-based logic. It acts as the primary medium to communicate institutional information such as courses and admissions. The project completely avoids external frameworks, relying purely on core web technologies (HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript).

2. Overall Description

2.1 Product Perspective

Nova is a standalone frontend prototype. It addresses the observation that many academic websites focus solely on functional information delivery and fail to convey the essence and atmosphere of the university. The product allows users to intuitively feel the spirit, academic ambition, and campus life of the institution through thoughtful visual design.

2.2 Operating Environment

- **Platform:** Standard modern web browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge).
- **Device Support:** Desktop, tablet, and mobile devices (Responsive Design).

2.3 Design and Implementation Constraints

The system must be built entirely using core web technologies without any external CSS or JavaScript frameworks. The user interface must comply with recognized Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG 2.1) and standard usability heuristics (e.g., Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics).

3. Functional Dependencies (Requirements)

The following functional dependencies define the interactive behaviors required for the client-side of the Nova platform.

- **FR-01: Navigation Menu Toggling:** The system shall provide an interactive, toggleable navigation menu allowing users to seamlessly transition between primary user flows such as browsing courses, admissions, and contact information.
- **FR-02: Interactive Visual Feedback:** All clickable UI elements (buttons, links, cards) must implement interactive hover states and active state styles to provide immediate user feedback upon interaction.
- **FR-03: Client-Side Form Validation:** The system shall implement JavaScript-based form validation to provide immediate feedback on user inputs (e.g., for admission or contact forms) prior to any mock submission events.
- **FR-04: Dynamic Content Rendering:** The system shall utilize JavaScript to dynamically render content elements across the user interface without requiring full page reloads, simulating modern single-page application behaviors natively.

4. Non-Functional Dependencies

- **NFR-01: Responsive Layout:** The GUI must employ CSS3 Flexbox and Grid layouts to ensure the interface is fully responsive, maintaining a balanced design across desktop, tablet, and mobile viewing environments.
- **NFR-02: Semantic Structural Integrity:** The markup must utilize semantic HTML5 tags (e.g., headers, navs, sections, footers) to ensure proper document structure for web accessibility and logical organization.
- **NFR-03: Usability and Aesthetics:** The design must rigorously apply core GUI principles including alignment, contrast, spacing, and consistency. Color schemes and typography must be emotionally resonant and suitable for an educational platform.

5. Team Breakdown & Roles

The project is collaboratively developed by students of the 4th Semester Integrated Masters in Software Development.

Name / ID	Academic Status	Project Roles & Responsibilities
Gargee Kakaty (IS-241-844-0013)	IMSc Software Dev (4th Sem)	Co-Developer & Designer UI/UX Design, CSS3 Layouts (Flexbox/Grid), Wireframing, and Visual Identity.
Kaustuva Kashyap (IS-241-844-0022)	IMSc Software Dev (4th Sem)	Co-Developer & Scripter JavaScript Logic, Form Validation, DOM Manipulation, and Dynamic

Name / ID	Academic Status	Project Roles & Responsibilities
		Rendering.

6. Project Phases & Timeline

The development cycle is charted from the first week of April 2026, culminating in the final project delivery on **May 20, 2026**.

Phase	Focus Area	Dates (2026)	Deliverables
Phase 1	GUI Design & Wireframing	April 1 – April 10	Identify primary user flows (courses, admissions). Create layout wireframes, select typography, and define the educational color scheme.
Phase 2	Core HTML/CSS Implementation	April 11 – April 25	Develop the semantic HTML5 structure. Apply CSS3 Flexbox and Grid to build out responsive layouts for headers, nav bars, and cards.
Phase 3	JavaScript	April 26 – May 10	Implement client-side logic:

Phase	Focus Area	Dates (2026)	Deliverables
	Interactivity		navigation toggling, interactive hover states, dynamic content rendering, and form validation feedback.
Phase 4	Testing & Delivery	May 11 – May 20	Ensure consistent responsiveness across devices. Validate against usability heuristics and WCAG 2.1 guidelines. Final project submission.